Mad Kanban: Getting Started

How to install Obsidian, connect to the team board and work with tasks. About 10 minutes, no experience needed.

What this is. We keep our tasks on a shared board, like sticky notes on a wall. Each task is a **card**, and cards move through four columns: **To Do**, **In Progress**, **Done** and **Archive**. The board runs inside **Obsidian**, a free app, and stays in sync with everyone: when someone changes a card, you see it within a second.

Every card belongs to a **project**. You only see the projects you have been added to, so the board may look different for you than for others.

A computer
Windows or Mac.

Your join link
Sent by your team host. Looks like `http://170.168.60.196:8787/#3f9c…`

10 minutes
You only do this once.

Your join link is your password. It signs you in as you. Don't share it or post it in group chats. If you lose it or think someone else has it, ask your host for a new one; the old link stops working.

1 Install Obsidian

1. Open **obsidian.md/download** in your browser.
2. Download the version for your computer and install it like any other app.
   Windows: run the downloaded `.exe` file. **Mac:** open the `.dmg` file and drag Obsidian into Applications.
3. Don't create a vault yet. Do step 2 first.

2 Download the ready-made folder

Obsidian works inside a folder called a **vault**. We have one ready with the Mad Kanban plugin already installed.

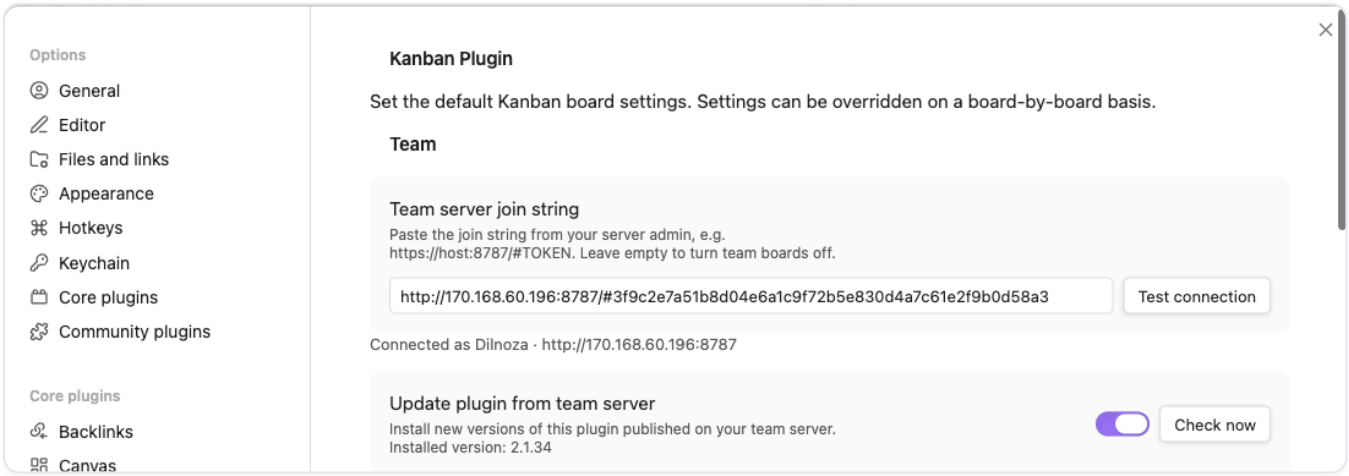
1. Download it: **`http://170.168.60.196:8787/download/mad-kanban-vault.zip`**
2. Move the zip to a place you'll keep it, for example your **Documents** folder.
3. Unzip it. **Windows:** right-click → **Extract All…** → **Extract**. **Mac:** double-click the zip.
   You now have a folder called **Mad Kanban**.

3 Open the folder in Obsidian

1. Start Obsidian. On the welcome screen, choose **Open folder as vault** → **Open**, and select the **Mad Kanban** folder.
   (Already used Obsidian before? Click the vault name at the bottom left → **Manage vaults…** → **Open folder as vault**.)
2. Obsidian asks **"Do you trust the author of this vault?"** Click **Trust author and enable plugins**. Without this the board can't load.

4 Connect with your join link

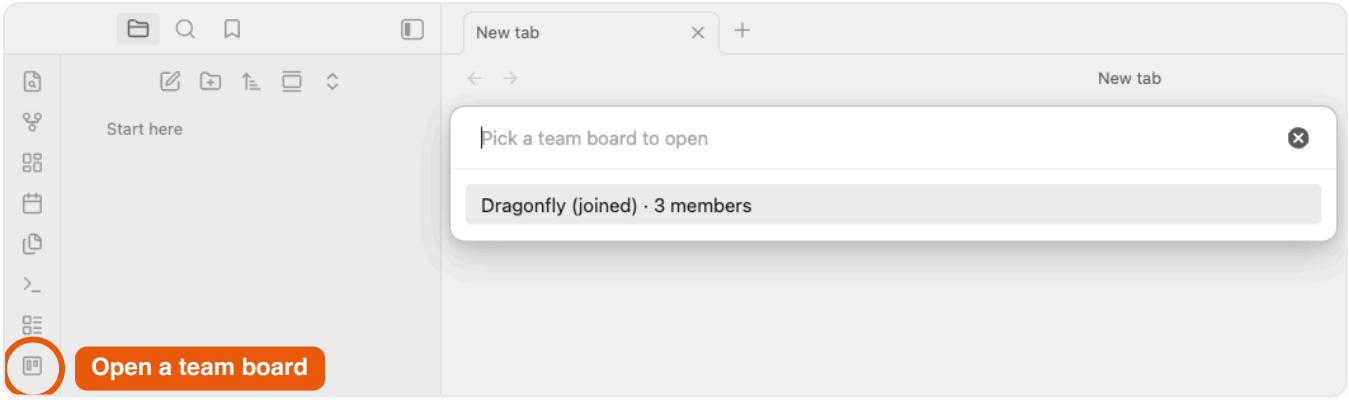
1. Click the **gear icon** at the bottom left to open **Settings**.
2. In the left list, under **Community plugins**, click **Mad Kanban**.
3. Paste your join link into **Team server join string**.
4. A line below it should say **Connected as** followed by your name. Close Settings.



Settings → Mad Kanban. After pasting the link it says "Connected as" with your name.

5 Open the team board

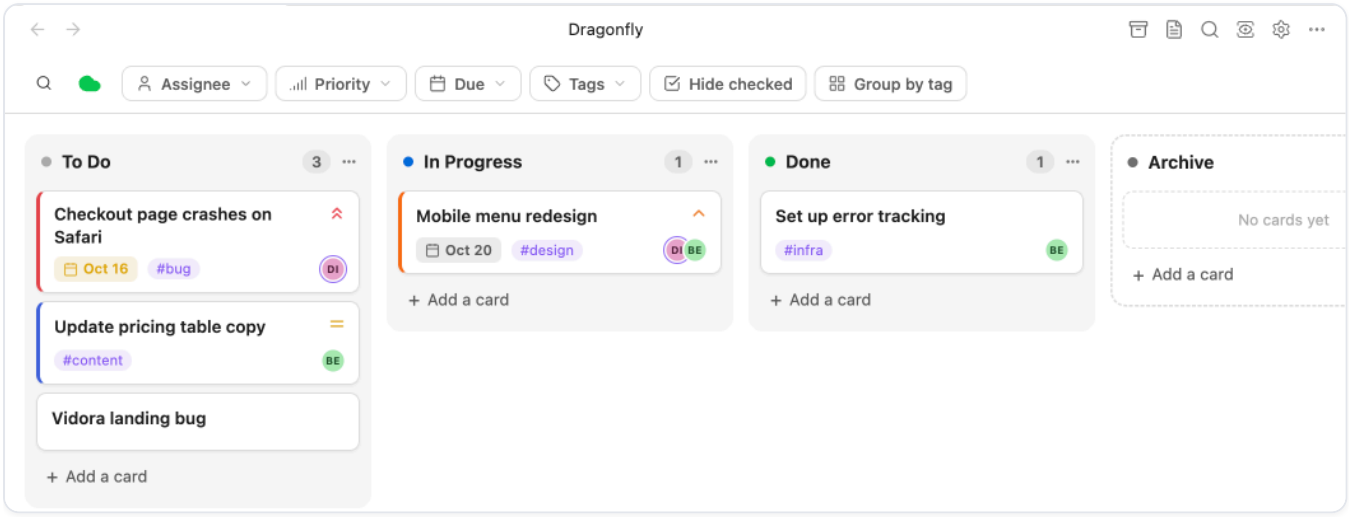
1. In the thin icon bar on the far left, click the **board icon** (it says **Open a team board** when you point at it).
2. Pick the board, for example **Dragonfly**. It opens and appears in your file list, so next time just click it there.



The board icon in the left bar opens the list of team boards.

That's it, you're set up. The rest of this guide shows how to work with the board.

6 Working with the board

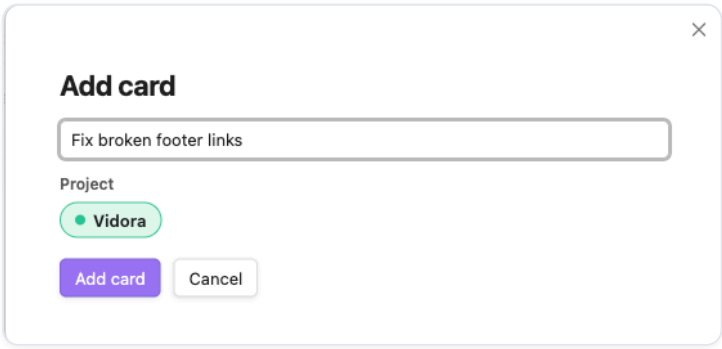


A board. Cards show their priority, due date, tags and who is working on them.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
Columns	**To Do** → **In Progress** → **Done**. **Archive** is for finished cards worth keeping. **Drag a card** to move it. Click a column name to fold it.
Arrow at the top right of a card	Priority, from double arrow up (highest) to arrow down (low). Cards are sorted by priority.
Date chip	Due date. It turns yellow when due soon and red when overdue.
`#tag`	Tags, for grouping and filtering.
Round initials	The people assigned to the card.
Speech bubble	Number of comments. **"2 new"** means comments you haven't read yet.
Coloured chip with a dot	The card's project (shown when you are in more than one project).
Cloud at the top left	● green: saved and synced ● yellow: saving ● orange: offline ● red: error. Click it to sync again.

Add a card

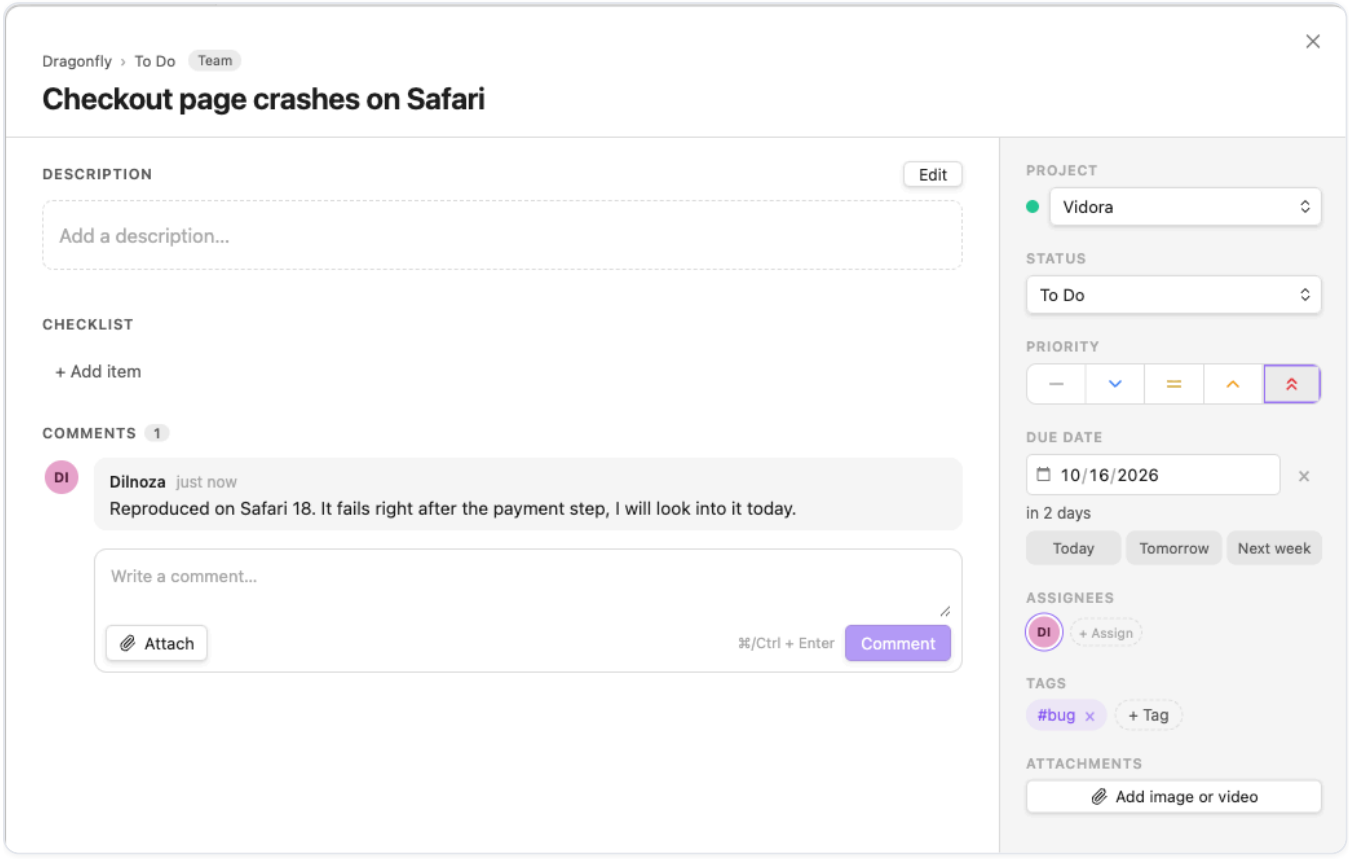
1. Click **+ Add a card** under a column.
2. Type a title and choose the **project**. You can only choose projects you are in.
3. Press Enter or click **Add card**.



The Add card window with the project choice.

7 Inside a card

Click a card to open it.



The card window: description, checklist and comments on the left, details on the right.

- **Description**: click **Edit** to write. You can paste screenshots straight in; click an image to see it full size.
- **Checklist**: small steps inside the task. Tick them off as you go.
- **Comments**: talk about the task. Point at a comment to **Reply** to it or **Edit** your own. Use **Attach** for images and videos. Ctrl / ⌘ + Enter sends.
- **Right side**: Project, Status (column), Priority, Due date, Assignees, Tags and Attachments. Changes save on their own.
- Press Esc or click × to close.

Find cards quickly

The bar above the board filters by **Project**, **Assignee**, **Priority**, **Due** and **Tags**. Choose **Assignee** → **Me** to see just your work. Your filters are remembered. The magnifier searches card text.

Archive or delete a card

Archive: drag the card into the **Archive** column. **Delete:** start dragging a card and a **Delete** area appears at the bottom of the screen; drop the card there and confirm.

Updates

The plugin updates itself. When a new version arrives you'll see **"Mad Kanban was updated"**. Click **Click here to reload it now**.

? If something doesn't work

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
The board doesn't open, or there's no board icon	The plugin is off. Settings → **Community plugins**: make sure **Restricted mode** is off and **Mad Kanban** is switched on.
"Not connected" or "Connection failed"	Check your internet, and that you pasted the **whole** link, including the part after `#`.
"Cannot reach team server", or the cloud is orange	No connection to the server. You still see the last loaded board. It syncs again when the connection is back.
"You are not in any project yet"	Ask your host to add you to a project.
A card a colleague mentions isn't on your board	It's in a project you're not in. Ask your host if you need access.
Lost your link, or new computer	Ask your host for a new link and paste it in Settings → Mad Kanban. The old link stops working.